

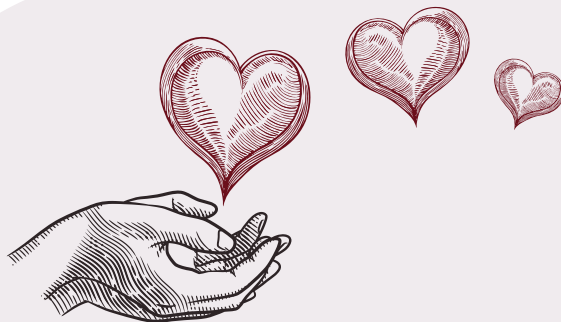
2026

Annual Report

OF THE CONGREGATION

"The only thing that counts
is faith working through love."

Galatians 5:6



LIVING *Generously*
LOVING *Boldly*



**TRINITY LUTHERAN
CHURCH & SCHOOLS**
BUILDING + BELONGING + BECOMING

Trinity Lutheran Church & Schools

Welcome

Whatever has led us here, whether it's a lifetime of faith or a lifetime of questions, days of joy or days of pain, moments of hope or moments of frustration, and no matter the color of our skin, our political affiliation, sexual orientations, gender identities, gender expressions, or age, **ALL ARE WELCOME!**

Focus

Building up and joining in God's mission as one
to nurture, love and serve all.

Impact

Effect Healing & Transformation in the Community.

Values

Christ-inspired **Service** in Our Community
(Local and Global)

Inclusion of All People

Impactful **Relationships** with One Another
that Provide Support for Life's Journey

Faith-based Communal Experience
of **Worshipping and Learning** Together

Multi-generational Ministry Relevant to all Ages
and Promoting Relationships Across Generations

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Hector Garfias-Toledo

Lead Pastor

The sun was bright and the sky was a mixture of clouds with a blue background. It was one of those days when we feel like Louis Armstrong would say in his song “What a Wonderful World”

*“I see skies of blue and clouds of white
The bright blessed days, the dark sacred night
And I think to myself
What a wonderful world.”*

Perhaps those were the same words that the apostle St. Paul would use those days when he saw the Christian faith community living harmoniously and striving to reflect the love of God with their entire lives.

At the same time, as I was browsing through web pages on the internet, I came across the news reports about the dark and despair caused by wars, political strife, blockades, and manipulation of resources and information. This is a time when we also think to ourselves “what has happened to this wonderful world?”

In his letter to the church in Galatia, one of the churches that seemed to be a powerful witness to the transformational and life-giving power of God in Jesus, he encourages the community to remember that the *“only thing that counts is faith made effective through love.”* Gal 5:6

Although they were faithful believers, they lived in a world that, like today, was affected by forces that tore apart societies and pushed the early Christian church to either resist or join the powerful to survive. While propaganda was disseminated to believe that power and control is what counts, the apostle missed no opportunity to remind us that what counts is faith made effective through love.

At Trinity Lutheran Church and Schools (TLCS), we believe that we, as part of the Lord’s Church, are joining God’s mission to nurture, serve, and

love all. We have the assurance that God has been gracious upon us, and we strive to be catalysts of healing and transformation for the common good in this community. In other words, we seek to live lives of faith that make a difference and have an impact in the community through love.



At our congregational meeting held in November last year, we committed to embrace and make our own the generosity emphasis titled **“Live Generously. Love Boldly.”** We committed to live lives that show and evoke generosity, and to love not as a matter of a feeling, but as an intentional decision to practice the essence of who we are as children of God and sibling with Christ.

It is my hope to convey to you the many ways in which I believe that TLCS has been a witness of a faith made effective through a bold love and generosity. And how we will join God in God’s work to restore hope, healing, transformation and wholeness in this wonderful world.

Let me begin by sharing **where I saw generosity come alive through our ministry this year.**

- Faithful participation in the generosity initiative with either your financial contribution or your presence and prayers.
- Missional generosity that allowed TLCS to share part of the 2025 contributions income with providers at the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center (LNC).
- Contributions to support Living Water projects, Cocoon House meals, and Neighbors in Need.

- Members and participants stepping up to lead and support ministries at a time of personnel transitions at TLCS.
- Support for the staff team by providing time off and constant notes of appreciation
- Sharing your life, joys, and resources with neighbors, friends, relatives, and anyone who shows up at the Sunday gathering of the church.
- Your generosity shines through the welcoming and hospitality that each one of you shows at gatherings and events of TLCS.

The **congregation's faith becomes active in love through your constant and consistent participation in the ministries of the congregation.** Perhaps the most visible is the conclusion of the church building siding and the LNC construction. Your commitment to make

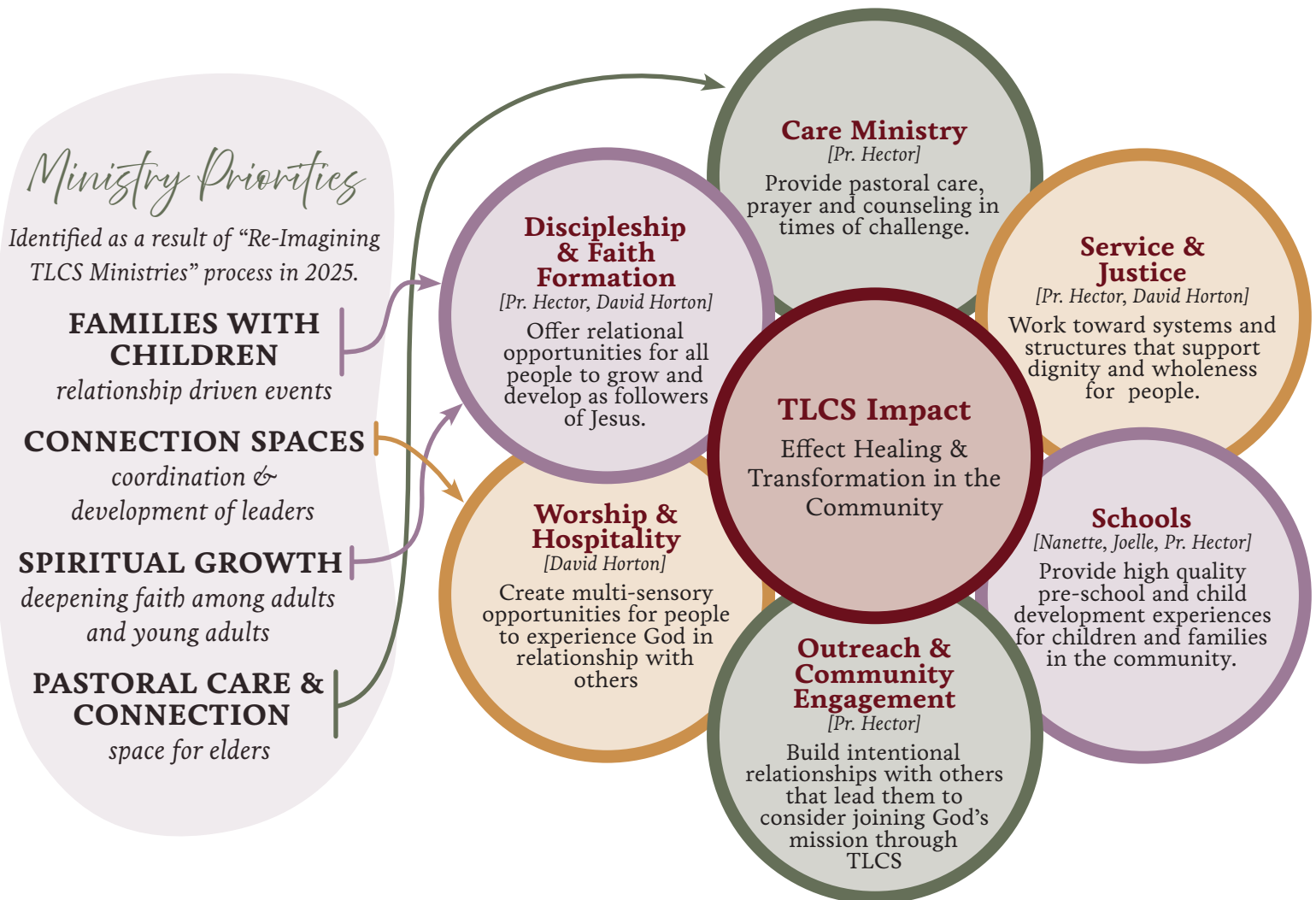
faith active in love is what gives meaning to the buildings that we care for and maintain.

In my report from last year,¹ I concluded by saying that we will continue to practice **adjusting, re-imagining, and letting go so that nothing will keep us from responding to the changes in the community.** You can also find my monthly reports in the Minutes & Materials documents on the Trinity website's Council page.²

Today, once again, I want to exhort you to intentionally seek the opportunities for the year ahead. Where do we sense possibilities for our ministry to continue growing, deepening relationships, and extending generosity, loving boldly?

1 - tlcs.church/q/annual2025

2 - tlcs.church/council



The Rearview Mirror Vision

Before we look forward, let's pause and take a look using our rearview mirror.

We celebrate and lift up the leadership of the congregation—both elected and non-elected leaders—and the staff members. All of whom have demonstrated a remarkable commitment and inspiring faithfulness. Especially, as the staff team (supported by the council) had to take some responsibilities when our Minister of Faith Formation, David Greenlee, went on disability leave in October.

Last year was a year for inward reflection and discernment. As a result of the end of Pr. Piro's interim work with TLCS and David Greenlee's disability leave, we decided to enter a discernment process called **"Reimagining TLCS' Ministry."** It was an introspective process that included forums, surveys, and conversations with members of the congregation to find out what the priorities of the congregation were. The year-long process generated insights that led us to rethink and re-imagine the staff configuration to address the ministry priorities of TLCS (see *chart & Ministry Priorities on the previous page*).

The sudden change in pastoral capacity and ministry with youth and families certainly had an effect on the ongoing implementation of the **Impact Model**. However, the core ministries approach was used for the process and provided us with direction to steward resources in order to respond to the pressing needs of the ministry.

Amid the Re-Imagining TLCS' Ministry process, we also were working on the generosity emphasis that we adopted in October last year.

As I mentioned above, the yearly generosity emphasis has helped TLCS by making generosity an integral part of the DNA of the congregation. Generosity has become a natural and normal pathway for the congregations and participants. It has also moved from financial contributions to a daily way of life. That is palpable in the way that we saw the response during the commitment

Sunday, and the subsequent weeks and months. Households and individuals with a "faith of leap" joined God's mission as one to nurture, love, and serve all.

We continued to integrate and instill the values of the congregation³ in every layer of ministry as guiding principles for decision making and strategic and ministry planning. These are some examples of ministry during last year:



Pastor Hector participates in both schools' chapel time.

- **Diversity and Inclusion Ministry Team** strategic organization and purpose driven ministry
- **Worship series rhythms** for the congregation that foster a deeper experience of the Sunday gathering of the church
- **Families with young children** fellowship and relational ministry
- Affirming the **full participation of children**, families, and senior members of the congregation in the church gathering by including them in the liturgy leadership
- Adjustments to the **hospitality ministry** through the coffee fellowship after worship
- Conveying an **authentic welcome** and practicing hospitality
- **TLCS-LNC Engagement** team
- TLCS **presence and participation in city** and public events
- **Garden ministry** practicing discernment and pivoting to better respond to the real capacity of the team.

3 - tlcs.church/about

- **Living Water** exploring creative ways to expand their network and impact in people's lives
- Strengthening of a **culture of collaboration** among the staff members
- **Intentional discernment** among elected leadership to foster healthy transitions of committees and team, collaboration, clarity of responsibilities and practicing apprenticeship.

Perhaps the most noticeable physical changes around TLCS were the siding project (including the signs for the main entrance and our schools) and the LNC building construction. Both projects were completed about the same time which brought a sense of fulfillment and joy. They have created a sense of energy, excitement, and new possibilities. Members of the community at large have joined the ministry, members of the congregation are already volunteering. God has provided for a new possibility to practice faith made effective in love!

A couple more reasons to be grateful are:

LEADERSHIP AND STAFF

- Both staff and leaders of the congregation were and continue to be a crucial support for the ministry and kept moving forward.
- The council granted, again, the staff a week day for time together (fellowship and/or retreat time)

WORSHIP

- We intentionally practiced different approaches to worship integrating "traditional" and "contemporary" liturgical practices. We especially integrated a rhythm of worship series.
- Children and elderly members participated in leading the communion liturgy
- Feedback from new participants was positive and encouraging. There has been a consistent influx of new participants who have found a home at TLCS.

- Members of the congregation are inviting friends and family. And the congregation is consistently growing in breadth and depth.

LEARNINGS FROM LAST YEAR

- **Endurance of the congregation.** Despite the limited time and bandwidth that I encounter, the congregation has shown endurance, commitment, and support. The congregation remained focused on the ministry.
- **Willingness to be adaptable.** As we tried new approaches to worship, i.e. Sacred Pause, the congregation was willing to explore and adapt to non-traditionally provided interactive worship experiences.
- **Genuine care for the disenfranchised.** TLCS' is a congregation with a strong sense of call for compassion, care, and justice. I personally was challenged to re-frame my views and value new approaches to serve and care for others at a time of political turmoil.
- **Authentic care for pastors.** The congregation has once again shown that they care for their pastors. Both council and congregation have fully supported me by affirming my coaching training (I am a Synod Active Coach⁴ and ELCA Active Coach⁵, and I am in the process to be a Professional Certified Coach⁶), long trips to visit family abroad, and my continuing education (trip to Malaysia⁷). Last year I had to go to Mexico four times to support my parents due to health challenges.
- **People are experiencing nurturing.** When people feel compelled to invite family, friends, and co-workers to church is a sign that the congregation is providing a nourishment that participants want to share with others. It is a sign of health and growth.

4 - tlcs.church/q/synodactivecoach

5 - elcacoaching.org/users/hector-garfias-toledo

6 - tlcs.church/q/professionalcertifiedcoach

7 - tlcs.church/q/hectormalaysia

AREAS FOR GROWTH

- Pathways for new participants to integrate in the life of the congregation.
- Hospitality practices that permeate every ministry, group, and individual in the congregation.
- Children and families ministry
- Ministry with youth
- Engagement with online participants and guests
- Defining the partnership with the LNC



The Windshield Vision

In St. Paul's letter to the Galatians, we read that he told the early church, *"Let us not become weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."* (Gal 6:9). So, as we move on and forward the question for TLCS is how the congregation will respond to God's overflowing generosity. First and foremost, we are called to be the channels of God's generosity, and God's love made tangible through love.

In the face of challenges and uncertainties we are not to become weary in doing good. But, what does it mean to be witnesses of God's goodness? How do we respond faithfully and love boldly in times of despair, divisions, hopelessness, and the belief scarcity?

To be honest, it is not easy to answer those questions. I cannot by my own know where to

start! That is the liminal space where the Spirit works and instructs us. Last year, the Spirit sustained us as we spent time re-imagining, finalizing projects, and re-rooting in the community.

Looking forward through the windshield I can see the same Spirit guiding us into a new chapter in the life and ministry of the congregation. The outcomes of the "Re-Imagining TLCS Ministry" discerning conversations point to an internal adjustment of the resources entrusted to us.

The focus of the next four to six months will be hiring or calling new staff members to address the ministry priorities that you identified.

The desired outcome is growth, strengthening of relationships, and deepening of our spiritual lives. In other words to position the congregation for "the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."

Personally I am nervous, yet confident in the power and wisdom of the Spirit to lead us to take the next step. By strengthening and deepening connections, trust, and spiritual growth among members and participants, TLCS will be ready to embark on new missional adventures.

One of the missional adventures being the ongoing relationship with our partners in ministry in the LNC. For instance, sharing resources, collaborating in community projects, and making this space a place for people to engage in honest, respectful, and life-giving relationships that heal wounds and instill a vision of unity and wholeness.

The newly created position called **"Relational Ministries Coordinator"** will be a catalyst for connections, accompaniment for new members, and a reminder for existing ministries and teams to develop paths for people to learn about and join ministries and accompany one another.

The **"Families, children, and Youth Coordinator."** will work with TLCS in reimagining the ministry for new families and their children in a way that we honor the legacy



left by the ministry of David Greenlee and other leaders, but also bring new visions and dreams that strengthen families and their children's spiritual lives and connect them with the entire congregation.

As you see, this year is a time for self-reflection and evaluation of our behavioral patterns in order to strive to live a "faith made effective through love."

St. Paul exhorted the newly "gentile" converts and the Jewish -Christians to not let "traditions" and prejudices cause division in the body of Christ. Instead they, and us, are called to be of the same mind that the Lord Jesus.

The question for us is how we will live the faith that has been given to be made effective in love. How empty are we willing to be to be filled with *"the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, forbearance, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control."* (Gal 5:22-23)

Internal changes in the body are possible as long as it is emptied first. In order to shift our patterns we need to deconstruct habits that prevent us from flourishing as individuals and as a community. My prayer is that each one of us will be willing to be transformed and embrace the idea that we are called to never be the same ("the same" is in reference to patterns that fossilize and eventually prevent us from being adaptable to the new ways of the Spirit).

One of the areas of ministry that we will work on is resume leadership summits, foster apprenticeship, and de-siloing ministries.

Recent data collected by the Barna Group⁸, suggests a surprising resurgence in church attendance among Gen Z (ages 18–24) in the US, with younger adults now attending church more regularly than older generations.

They are driven by a search for authenticity, community, and traditional theology, this trend is reversing decades of decline. However, some

analysts argue it represents a stabilization rather than a full-scale "revival."

We will address the ongoing influx of new participants at TLCS with the support of the Relational Ministries Coordinator, we will develop pathways for newcomers to navigate their search and faith journey by accompanying them.

Like last year, this year will continue to instill the normal and natural pathways for generosity and refining the pathways of the congregation to equip and release people for leadership (discipleship).

Ministries and Leadership

In light of what I have shared with you above, we will continue to implement the principles of the impact model to help ministries to focus on outcomes that contribute to the overarching impact of the congregation. These are some principles that will be key in our work for the common good:

1. Leadership is directly proportional to discipleship
2. Collaboration and connections strengthen ministries
3. Focus on a few ministries in order to go deeper
4. Spiritual deepening that connects us with God and with the community
5. Intentional connections with the community at large
6. Apprenticeship as leadership development
7. Intergenerational ministry as the basis for passing the faith on
8. Worship community & Schools intentional collaboration and interaction

8 - [barna.com/research/young-adults-lead-resurgence-in-church-attendance](https://www.barna.com/research/young-adults-lead-resurgence-in-church-attendance)

TLCS Values Lived Out

This is how I believe that the values of the congregation will guide us in working for the common good of the community (congregation and community at large):

GOD-INSPIRED SERVICE IN OUR COMMUNITY (LOCAL AND GLOBAL)

New opportunities are emerging at the TLCS-LNC as we develop a plan for partnerships. Also, the Living Water Ministry, TLCS Gardening for Neighbors ministry,⁹ Cocoon House meals, and Neighbors in Need ministries continue **to be an extension of God's divine compassion**. (You can read their reports)

INCLUSION OF ALL PEOPLE

The Diversity and Inclusion Team (DIM)¹⁰ developed a statement that has been adopted by the congregation to guide TLCS in living out what it means **to be an extension of the welcome of the Lord Jesus**. New members and participants have expressed that TLCS is striving to live out this value by truly practicing hospitality, welcoming, and inclusion. It is palpable.

IMPACTFUL RELATIONSHIPS THAT SUPPORT OUR LIFE'S JOURNEY

Perhaps one of the most notable examples of intentional building of impactful relationships was the implementation of the **Trinity Families Fellowship**. Families with young children began to get together on the first Sunday of the month to build meaningful, deep, and lasting relationships around a meal together. At the same time the fellowship was a way to rewatch out new families and integrate them into the life of the congregation.

9 - youtube.com/watch?v=l_qijh_dIzo

10 - tlcs.church/dim

FAITH-BASED COMMUNAL EXPERIENCE OF WORSHIP AND LEARNING

We focused on **gatherings and learning sessions that nurture, heal, challenge, and orient our faith** so that every person will leave the gathering with a sense of direction and strength to be the scattered church during the six days of the week. For instance, the book studies during the worship series, especially during Lent.

Another tangible example of how TLCS is living by the values is the invaluable **support and accompaniment offered by adult leaders** to the highschool and middle-school students (NET and ZOE), and the tremendous work of the members of the congregation who have led the Sunday School.

MULTIGENERATIONAL MINISTRY

As I said last year, some of you and your children would be invited to **co-lead worship** and bring the message. Some of you participated in the "Conversations on the Road" series during the summer. **Young worshipers and elderly lead the communion liturgy** some Sundays, and some of you have brought the message for young worshipers and the congregation. **We are a liturgy church**, meaning a congregation in which liturgy is the work of the people, not just a set of words that we read from the hymnal.

We have begun the implementation of an **apprenticeship model** to identify, equip, and release a new generation of leaders.

Final Remarks & Action Steps

There is no doubt that this year is bringing new challenges that will make us wonder how we will be able to overcome and break through them.

The Spirit urges us to "see skies of blue and clouds of white, the bright blessed days, the dark sacred night, and to think to ourselves what a wonderful world God has entrusted to us."

The Lord has given his church all that is needed to carry out the ministry. Let us not become weary in doing good, live generously, and love boldly. The fruit of it will be the healing and transformation of the community within and outside TLCS. Faith made effective through love is the means through which God's reign of reconciliation, beauty, justice, and wholeness becomes tangible through each one of us.

My dear siblings in Christ, I exhort you to unite in a common and shared purpose as a congregation that seeks to be a transforming presence in the community.



This year we will bring new staff members who will join God's mission to re-imagine and re-envision how this growing congregation will respond and be a place where every person will experience God's embrace of grace and reconciliation.

Inclusion will be who we are, not what we do, will be a liminal space for growth where we ask questions, share our doubts, and accompany one another.

The main aspects of ministry that we will work on are:

- Leadership and staff. Equipping new leaders through an apprenticeship model and hiring of new staff.
- Church gathering and Spiritual growth. We will shift from making the Sunday gathering the only way of worship. We will implement small steps to practice being church seven days a week and worship a way of life.

- Thoughtful and faithful response to social and communal issues. We will seek ways to strengthen partnerships with the LNC, and we will address matters that affect the community by learning to use our critical thinking and spiritual guidance.
- Generosity and stewardship of resources. We will continue seeking ways to live generously with open hands and hearts. And we will engage in a new project to enhance and maintain facilities for the sake of ministry, specifically the replacement of the lighting system in the sanctuary.

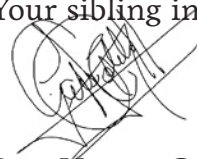
In sum, the ministry of the congregation will have an impact in the lives of every person in and outside this congregation. We will continue to be the scattered church that builds spaces for growth, reconciliation, and wholeness, and also brings healing and transformation every day, everywhere, all the time. A place where people find home and the support for this life's journey. That is why, my prayer and hope is that we all will constantly reflect and intentionally listen to one another, deeply, curiously, and humbly.

We will continue to practice adjusting, reimagining, and letting go so that nothing will keep us from responding to the changes and new needs in the community.

I want to express my most sincere gratitude to God and to you all for the opportunity to serve alongside you, and for the care, support, and accompaniment that you have graciously given to the staff and to me through the entire year. Especially at a time when I have to care for my parents in Mexico.

You will be in prayers, but I want to ask for your prayers asking God to give me the strength, humbleness, openness, and the will to serve you and serve with you in the love of the Lord Jesus. Thanks be to God for all of you!

Your sibling in Christ,



Rev. Hector Garfias-Toledo, Lead Pastor



Trinity Schools

Every child who walks through the doors of Trinity Preschool or the Child Development Center is met with something that can't always be measured: the experience of being known, cared for, and loved. Trinity's schools are not simply an educational program — they are a ministry, an expression of the congregation's conviction that generosity begins with the youngest among us and that investing in children is one of the most faithful things a community can do.

In 2025, God's presence was woven through storytime and playtime, through the patient work of teachers and the trust of families. What follows reflects that ministry in numbers and in spirit — and reminds us that the seeds planted in these earliest years carry the promise of a lifetime.

Trinity Child Development Center

It is 2026 and Trinity Child Development Center is serving upward of 75 families each week!

Our rooms are full of children between the ages of 4 months and 6 years receiving full day childcare and loving support from a staff of 26 capable educators/care-givers.

We ask that as you consider the ministries of Trinity Lutheran Church and Schools, you pray for our teaching staff by name. Ask for God's holy guidance as we nurture and teach this next generation.



OUR CDC STAFF

Amy, Andrew, Ashlee, Ashley, Ashlynn, Brenda, Crystal, Debbie, Donnā, Evie, Huriya, Indi, Jessica, Cassidy, Kathy, Kaylie, Kiesha, Kimberly, Laura, Lauren, Lindsay, Nanette, Ronica, Rosa, Sandra, Teresa. We are diverse in age, land of origin, faith expression, educational background, experience, personal expression, and orientation but united in our care, commitment and love for the children we serve.

Trinity has built a reputation for meeting the needs of children and families over the last **31 years**. It is a joy to see a second generation of families in our numbers. We are currently **serving children of alumni** and have **teaching staff who were students** here in their formative years and now serve in the faith community of their childhood. We continue to build a place of



Trinity Preschool

This past year has truly been a season of blessings for our preschool, and as I reflect on all that we've experienced, my heart is filled with deep gratitude.

First and foremost, I want to recognize and thank the incredible group of women who make this place so special—Kari Dobbs, Silvia SanJuan, Lindsay Stark, Natasha Pia Kamakeeaina, Mallory McCollum, and Elizabeth Shaffer (2024–25 school year).



care and trust that people feel secure in returning to with their own families. This year we also included the opportunity for families to donate to and supplement from a small food pantry when SNAP funds were temporarily suspended, feeding body, mind and spirit of families who needed it.

We look forward to new collaborations with our neighbors in the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center to offer a wide variety of support options to current and future families utilizing our ministries.

We continue to offer many opportunities for family engagement with staff, other families within the childcare community and the family of Trinity ministries. The CDC works in coordination with TLP and the Sunday worshiping community to provide these experiences together:

Lenten suppers, National Night Out, Trunk or Treat, Christmas Craft Night, and weekly worship services.

Together in Ministry,

Nanette Erban

Director, Trinity Child Development Center



Each day, they walk through our doors with genuine smiles, open hearts, and a deep love for the children they serve. It is not only what they do, but how they do it—the patience they show, the encouragement they offer, the laughter they share, and the safe, nurturing environment they create that leaves a lasting impact on every child. Because of them, our preschool is not just a place of learning, but a place where children feel seen, valued, and truly cared for.

I am deeply grateful for their dedication, compassion, and the difference they make each and every day. It is a true blessing to work alongside such an extraordinary team.

This year, generosity was also demonstrated through a series of successful events hosted in collaboration with both our Church and Schools, including National Night Out, Trunk or Treat,

the Christmas Play, Christmas Craft Night, Lenten Suppers, and our end-of-year concert and gathering.



Across each of these events, our team consistently embodied generosity through their time, talents, and hospitality. Volunteers contributed many hours to planning, organizing, and serving, ensuring that all who attended felt welcomed and valued. From preparing meals and leading activities to fostering meaningful connections, their commitment was evident at every level.

These gatherings provided meaningful opportunities to serve and engage with others. Whether creating safe and inclusive spaces for families, fostering fellowship through shared meals, or bringing people together through music and celebration, our team demonstrated a deep commitment to care and service.

Collectively, these efforts reflect a culture of generosity that extends beyond individual acts, highlighting an ongoing dedication to building relationships, supporting others, and strengthening community connections.

Over the Christmas season, our community also came together to support one of our preschool families in need. It was a powerful reminder that faith is not only something we speak about, but something we live out through our actions. When we learned of their situation, our Church community responded immediately with open

hearts. Many donated clothing and gift cards, while Preschool families contributed food and additional gifts.

Seeing everyone coming together in this way was truly meaningful. It was not only about meeting practical needs, but also about offering love, kindness, and encouragement during a difficult time. The family was supported and uplifted, and we were reminded that even small acts of generosity, when united, can make a lasting impact.

Looking ahead, we see meaningful opportunities to continue growing and strengthening our ministry. We hope to deepen relationships with our families, Church, and School community through more intentional connections and shared experiences.

We also look forward to building on the success of this year's events by continuing to offer opportunities that foster belonging, hospitality, and joy. Above all, we remain committed to supporting families in meaningful ways and responding to their needs with care and compassion.

We are excited for a year of continued growth, deeper connections, and ongoing opportunities to live out generosity in both small and impactful ways.

I feel incredibly blessed to be part of this amazing community and look forward with gratitude and joy to continuing my service at Trinity Lutheran Church and Schools.

Joelle Dudak
Director, Trinity Preschool



Administration & Council

The work of governance and administration may not make headlines, but it is the foundation on which everything else rests. The Congregation Council, committees, and staff who tend to the finances, operations, and institutional health of Trinity do so as an act of faithful stewardship — caring for what God has entrusted to this community so that the ministry can continue, deepen, and grow. It is quiet, often unglamorous work, and it matters enormously.

In 2025, Trinity's leadership held the whole with integrity — navigating the ordinary rhythms of institutional life while keeping the mission clearly in view. The reports that follow offer transparency and accountability to the congregation, and an invitation to trust that the foundation beneath this community is strong. What God has called us to do, God also equips and sustains.

Report of the Administrator

As I complete year seven of ministry together with the good people of Trinity Lutheran Church & Schools, and year twenty in full time church administration, I continue to find life and energy through the work that goes on here daily.

Below is a partial list of some of the projects and activities that brought that life and energy to my work in 2025, and some of what's ahead for the rest of 2026.

LYNNWOOD NEIGHBORHOOD CENTER (LNC) OPENING

A few weeks after starting at Trinity, construction broke ground on Phase I of the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center (LNC) project. Seven years later, after a global pandemic, a change in leadership at our partners Volunteers of America Western Washington, and numerous other bumps in the path to completion, the LNC opened its doors in January, 2026 and is now serving our community in the ways we had hoped and dreamed of for more than a decade.

Looking ahead, while there are logistical challenges that still need to be worked out, the opportunities for fruitful partnerships with

VOAWW and its LNC tenants far outnumber the potential conflicts. I personally look forward to being a part of these partnerships and increasing our participation in tenants' gatherings and other joint operations meetings.

Since the grand opening event on January 24, I have had conversations about potential partnerships and / or logistics planning with:

- Meisha Wangerin, LNC Site Director
- Ken Cooper, Unit Director (Edmonds) Boys & Girls Club of Snohomish County
- Cory Armstrong-Cross, Executive Director Senior Services at VOAWW
- Etmon Carranza, Lynnwood Community Resource Center Program Manager



OTHER COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS CULTIVATED

In addition to new community relationship opportunities opened up by the LNC, I continued work fostering other relationships with community organizations. The “Cops & Kids” basketball program—a partnership between Trinity, the Lynnwood Police Department, and organized by The Access Project—entered its second year on Tuesday nights. This Fall,

the program expanded to include Panthers girls volleyball program, and there is youth basketball or volleyball now happening in our gym every Tuesday evening.

The Access Project is a community non-profit organization providing mentorship and support to at-risk youth, and is led by Wally Webster, Lynnwood's "Man of the Year" in 2025. Wally will be losing his current office space at some point in 2026, and we have been in discussions with him about renting space at Trinity House, and are hopeful that could happen (along with tenant improvements) as soon as this summer.

We also continued to host Orchestra Northwest, a Latino youth music program, on Monday nights, welcome various other neighborhood basketball and volleyball groups (youth and adult) in the gym, and rent space for local choral and other classical music group concerts and recitals in the Sanctuary.



FACILITY IMPROVEMENTS

After completing the roof replacement project in 2024, we completed our siding project in 2025—on time and on budget! The crumbling stucco siding was replaced with longer lasting and easier to maintain "Hardie Board" siding along the walls, and water resistant single layer stucco along the parapets. Additionally, new signage was installed at the main entrance and schools' entrances that greatly improved the clarity of entrance into our building (an especially important consideration given the opening of the LNC on our campus).

Exterior lighting was also improved and increased around the building and throughout the campus.

We completed both the siding and roof projects through the generous contributions of our membership during the "Build Up, Branch Out" campaign, and both projects are completely paid off without the need for additional financing. Thank you!

Looking to the year ahead, we are going to be replacing the lighting console for the Sanctuary that is past its life expectancy (and no longer working properly) this Spring, and hope to replace and upgrade Sanctuary lighting further later in the year., pending a planned post-Easter campaign to raise additional funds.

This summer, we also are planning on resealing and painting the parking lot and demolishing the old sheds and constructing a new garbage/recycle corral. We are also hoping for some improvements to Trinity House in partnership with our potential new tenant.

GENEROSITY & STEWARDSHIP

In 2025, we saw a decrease in total commitments, but a significant increase in giving amongst returning contributors. We also had six new giving / pledging households. However, even with new households joining the congregation and beginning to contribute financially, and the continued generosity of long-time members, this will be an area of challenge for our budget in the years ahead given the aging demographics of our congregation.

PERSONNEL AND STAFFING

2025 was another largely quiet year in terms of church staffing. Unfortunately, our long-time Minister of Faith Formation, David Greenlee, had to go on a long-term medical leave this past Fall. Gratefully, disability leave was approved through our benefits program, and while David will no longer be leading our youth and children's ministries, he will remain a part of the Trinity community as he continues to find a resolution to his medical issues.

David's departure, coupled with the need for additional pastoral help in the absence of a second pastor, have led to the formation of multiple teams to hire new staff members in 2026. These new positions were discussed and included as part of the 2026 budget process at the end of last year, and the work of recruitment and hiring is

ongoing. I will continue to provide support to these teams and the Personnel Committee as they fill these new positions.

Don Boelter

Trinity Administrator

2025 Statistical Report

407

Active Members

70

Average Online Worship Attendance

1

Affirmations of Baptism

159

Average In-Person Worship Attendance

7

Members Received

3

Baptisms Performed

11

Member Deaths



Blessing the LNC following worship on January 23, 2026



Members of Trinity's delegation to the NW Wa Synod Assembly

Report of the President

My fellow Siblings in Christ,

I have had the great privilege to take the torch that President Mark Schmidt and our previous Council have carried so faithfully these past four years!

As I step into this leadership role, I am reminded of the 20th Chapter of Acts, where Paul bolsters and encourages the next group of Ephesians who will lead the Christian church. The chapter's theme centers on ensuring the message of the resurrection (Acts) is never lost, but rather, actively transferred to others who can continue the work.

Mark and I sat down several times during our transition period from March to June last year to (indeed) encourage me and to fill me in on what actions and efforts the Council had devoted their attention. During this transition period, Mark and the Council highlighted these actions:

- **Ministry staffing:** assessed the results from the congregational needs assessment and "Reimagining TLCS Ministry" forums.
- **2025 Generosity Initiative:** considered themes and potential missional partners.
- Small **building repairs:** options for the gift/bequest from Gloria Dei Lutheran.
- A potential **sabbatical for Pr. Hector.**

Other, routine business items included the following:

- Affirmed Pr. Hector's work as internship supervisor/coach for pastoral candidate

Salvador Cossio, in partnership with Pr. Chad Johnson at Grace Lutheran, Des Moines.

- Approved miscellaneous easements for the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center.
- Council filled a position on the Personnel Committee.
- Adopted a protocol for interactions with immigration officers.

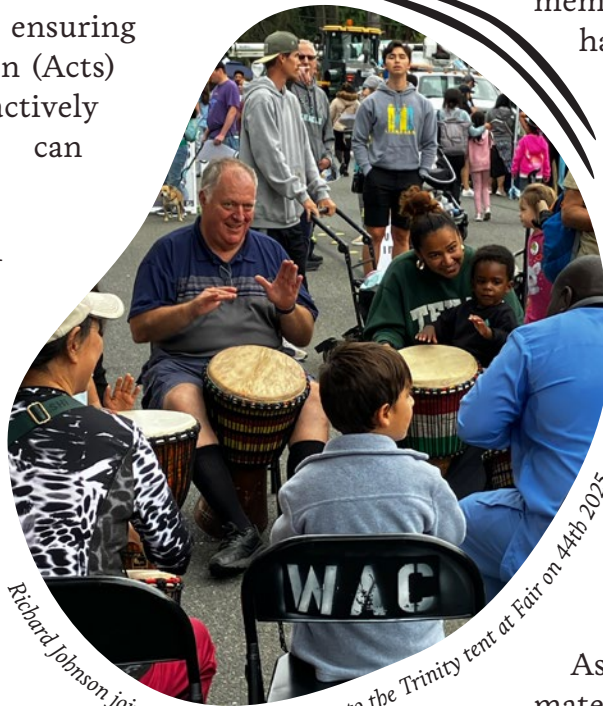
I began the president's role in July with a Council that welcomed Evy Strand, Mike Schultz, and me with grace and love. Many of the members of the sitting Council had decided to continue with a 2nd term, and I now see that same decision with another set of Council members at this next election term. Their willingness to extend their service demonstrates their energized commitment but also the health and vigor of our congregation.

One of the summer events that several of us council members attended was the **Lynnwood "Fair on 44th".**

As we shared our testimony and materials from our CDC, Preschool, and congregational ministries, we met many interested people seeking to learn more about our Lutheran perspective.

As I took a walk along the street and looked at the other booths and food vendors, I noted that the population profile in Lynnwood has vastly changed in the 30 years I've lived here. I felt like I was on a world tour with stops in Southeast Asia, India, China, Africa, and even a few middle European countries.

Today, I see that same richness and vibrancy of the world at large in our sanctuary on any Sunday. Our congregation benefits from having the **wisdom and perspective of differing cultures**, all coming together in harmony to do



Richard Johnson joining a drum circle next to the Trinity tent at Fair on 44th 2025

God's work. There truly is a cultural shift in our congregation with new faces in Sunday School, Choir, and our Ministries that depict diversity in Race, Gender, and Age. Our Diversity and Inclusion Ministry (DIM) reminds us that the inherent dignity of every person is honored by starting from a foundation of inclusion and celebration of the uniqueness of every individual.

It is on this foundation that your Council works to govern and steward the gifts that you so generously give in time, talent, and treasure.

Last fall, the Council approved the “**Living Generously, Loving Boldly**” stewardship campaign, with materials brought to fruition by Josh Judd-Herzfeldt.

The Council worked many extra meetings to produce a 2026 budget based on the commitments from the stewardship campaign – which is both a stretch budget, but also likely to balance at year's end. We are in a transitional growth period.

An essential part of the 2026 budget was much work done by the Personnel Committee and the Council to create **job descriptions for the three part-time positions of Pastoral Care Minister; Families, Children, and Youth Coordinator; and Relational Ministries Coordinator**. Also included in the budget is the future full time **Deacon position**, the role of “Minister of Word and Service”.

OTHER ITEMS IN BRIEF THAT THE COUNCIL HAS BEEN RESPONSIBLE FOR THIS YEAR:

- Council approved and coordinated the Disability Leave of David Greenlee.
- Special Congregational Meeting was held by Council to approve Phase 1 of the Sanctuary Lighting Project in January.
- LNC Opening in January:
 - Acceptance of LNC Board final report and recommendations. Their work will be the foundation for our continued relationship with LNC and VOAWW.

- Acknowledgment of Kerry Fleiger-Holmes who hosted a table for TLCS at the Grand Opening.

- Council initiated a Ministry Site Profile (MSP) committee formed to support hiring of the Pastoral Care Minister. They completed their work in early March and our position is currently posted with the Synod.
- Winter Retreat was held at the Rankin's for Council members to strategize, set goals, and build relationships.
- Council approved the Lighting Capital Campaign to finish Phase II and III needs.
- Sabbatical approved for Pastor Hector, starting after Easter 2027. A huge effort done by the Mutual Ministry team of Vianne Reay and Branda Anderson, Council Members and designated members to fill out and submit the Lilly Foundation Grant request. This has been successfully received and grants will be awarded August 28, 2026.

My deep gratitude to **Jenny Louch, Council Secretary**, as she steps away to other ministry callings, and to **Vice President Clint Buetow** who was also head of the Personnel Committee this year. Their support and leadership have been essential to my success.

As we move further into this year, I reflect on the sense of wholeness, warmth, goodwill, and peace I see in our interactions with each other. I see love acted out. I am humbled to see us live out that passage from Galatians 5:6 “The only thing that counts is faith working through love.”

Your sibling in Christ,

Bill Rankin

Congregation Council President



Report of the Treasurer

In many ways the years of 2025 and 2026 are transition years for Trinity Lutheran Church and Schools. Anticipation of the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center (LNC) opening was an important dynamic for our church community and South Snohomish County last year. During 2025 we learned more about the community service organizations scheduled to fill the LNC. It was exciting to hear the service activities and goals of these organizations and at the same time watch the LNC construction advance week-to-week. During the year, our church community continued our broad based local and international ministries, which we highlight on our website, in our What's Happening newsletter, and during our Generosity Moments. It is such a blessing to participate in God's calling for our congregation with opportunities to serve both locally and internationally.

Reviewing our financial experience, 2025 had the loss of donations from the passing of six long-time members and a few other church members moving out-of-state, representing a total of nine households. At the same time, as communications about the LNC increased, we had more visitors exploring our congregation and asking what it was about our community that supported development of the LNC and the significant multi-generational and multi-ethnic social services planned at the center. During the year giving increased by many members and visitors, yet 2025 total contributions received declined \$62,874 from 2024.

During November and December 2025, we received 83 pledges compared to 100 the prior year. The total amount pledged was nearly the same. Donation pledges received for our 2026 budget year include six new giving and pledging households. The **77 households that continued to provide a pledge for 2026 had a net increase of \$30,970**. Thank you for your generosity and support of our community's ministries!

2025 Year-End Report

CASH RESERVES

US Bank - \$334,557

Mission Investment Funds - \$839,533

Total - \$1,174,091

MORTGAGE BALANCE

\$1,361,064

DEDICATED FUNDS

\$225,322

(\$102,370 for Capital Fund)

School's Performance

CHILD DEVELOPMENT CENTER

2025 income - \$1,437,754

2025 expenses - \$1,505,620

Cash reserves: \$181,682 (\$10,050 is dedicated)

PRESCHOOL

2025 income - \$241,103

2025 expenses - \$246,511

Cash reserves: \$39,179 (\$1,154 is dedicated)

Supporting the increased interest in our church by visitors and the community, the Council recommended that we position our **2026 budget as a growth budget**, which was supported by feedback received from the congregation during our November 2025 budget forums and November 9, 2025 congregation meeting.

The discernment conversations, lead by Pastor Hector during spring, summer and fall of 2025, laid the groundwork to **adjust our staffing plans**. Rather than filling the open Associate Pastor position, we developed a budget that supported new staff positions that specifically focused on Pastoral Care, a Youth Coordinator, and a Relational Ministries Coordinator. In addition, David Horton completed his studies and the process needed to be called as a Deacon within the ELCA.

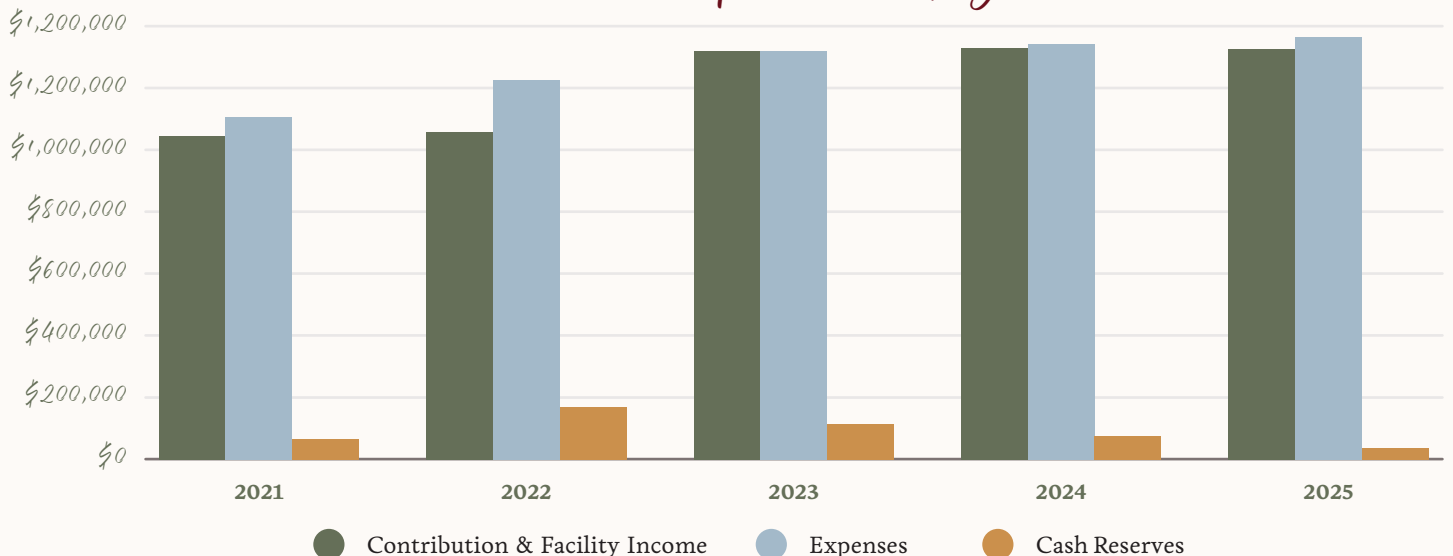
Church Income

	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Contributions	\$1,043,563	\$1,035,325	\$1,169,396	\$1,130,486	\$1,067,543
Facility Use	\$525	\$18,367	\$26,419	\$21,757	\$29,516
Miscellaneous*	\$339,142	\$3,732	\$150,553	\$174,431	\$224,574
TOTAL	\$1,383,284	\$1,057,424	\$1,346,368	\$1,326,674	\$1,321,636

Church Expense

	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Mission Support (to Synod)	\$62,614	\$62,205	\$81,840	\$100,134	\$75,528
Personnel	\$870,400	\$735,935	\$807,065	\$792,093	\$798,316
Mortgage	\$98,196	\$98,196	\$98,196	\$98,196	\$120,228
Faith Formation	\$1,522	\$2,849	\$2,856	\$2,902	\$2,481
Evangelism Ministry	\$1,197	\$1,350	\$1,021	\$1,445	\$1,668
Facility Ministry	\$140,811	\$178,224	\$176,127	\$192,643	\$195,954
Congregational Life	\$671	\$369	\$1,565	\$1,705	\$3,870
Management	\$124,253	\$122,609	\$127,198	\$132,270	\$136,676
Social Concerns	\$--	\$294	\$49	\$701	\$721
Worship	\$7,502	\$15,397	\$15,088	\$14,689	\$19,020
WAY Student Ministries	\$4,433	\$6,726	\$5,323	\$4,548	\$5,762
TOTAL	\$1,311,599	\$1,224,154	\$1,316,328	\$1,341,326	\$1,360,225

Income & Expense History**



* 2021 includes PPP Funds; 2023 & 2024 include ERC Funds; 2025 includes PPP/ERC funds & School contributions

**Income & Expense History chart includes only Contribution & Facility Use income to illustrate gap between true income & expense

Our **2026 budget funds these staffing and ministry transitions**, providing increased flexibility arising out of the LNC opening year (Official opening on January 5, 2026). The majority of Council's work year-to-date 2026 has focused on filling these new staff positions to relieve the very heavy pastoral care and leadership load that Pastor Hector is carrying.

As part of the **2026 growth focused budget**, with the growth focused on staff support of our ministries and growth of the congregation, we could experience a shortfall of income versus expenses for a period of time. While

other opportunities could benefit from our undesignated donations received in prior years, we see the **staffing adjustments as the best investment for the future ministry of our congregation** and service to God's calling. With the Spirit's guidance and support, we anticipate financial support will follow the increased ministries and outreach opportunities supported by the new staff positions.

Mike Schultz

Congregation Council Treasurer

Mission Budget

Figures represent 2026 budget. Personnel, facility, and mortgage expenses are divided proportionally between the Core Ministries. "Service & Justice" includes benevolence funds: 7% for Synod Mission Support and 2% for the Mission Giving Fund.



Northwest Washington Synod
Evangelical Lutheran Church in America
God's work. Our hands.

\$74,728

2025 NW Washington
Synod Mission Support

COCOON
HOUSE
Breaking the Cycle of Homelessness

\$11,467

2025 Mission Giving Fund
benevolence to Cocoon House

Worship & Hospitality

(43% | \$561,944)

Care Ministry

(8% | \$104,548)

Schools (CDC & Preschool)

(17% | \$222,163)



Service & Justice

(13% | \$169,890)



Outreach & Community Engagement Outreach

(7% | \$91,479)



Discipleship & Faith Formation

(12% | \$156,822)



Report of the Nominating Committee

The Nominating Committee saw generosity come alive through personal encounters, first amongst ourselves and then with potential candidates. This marked the greatest gift of serving, that is, getting to know each other by telling our stories. We built strong relationships within the team by spending time at meetings discussing our lives: family issues, struggles, challenges, successes, hopes, dreams, failures. This intimacy led to working well together through open, caring and respectful dialogue. This foundation enabled us to go into the congregation and courageously ask others to serve.

We learned to faithfully seek our God-given gifts, abilities, talents and knowledge and those of the congregants we approached. This understanding and appreciation enabled us to fill the slate of open positions with confidence. Those nominated will continue to guide and grow our ministries through the coming years. Our candidates will faithfully serve with love and inclusion of all within the congregation and the community. As Christians, we grew trying to walk through life in general and the task at hand as Jesus modeled, through faith in all and love for all.

We hope all serving in all the different capacities will experience the same great enjoyment that we did by building relationships through interactions amongst their teams, the congregation and community. Through these interactions, you will find as we did that congregation is filled with “seven-days-a-week” Christians.

Aaron Lindstrom & Mary Eaton

Nominating Committee Co-Chairs

Committee Members: Aaron Lindstrom, Mary Eaton, Pastor Hector Garfias-Toledo, Chris Morris, David Fox, John Judd, Michelle Weber

Nominees

*To be voted on at the 2026
Annual Congregational Meeting*

CONGREGATIONAL COUNCIL

*Ryan Jahn, Vice President
Courtney Spadaro, Secretary
Mark Bergquist, Member
Mark Reay, Member
Mary Denny, Member*

ENDOWMENT COMMITTEE

*Christina Howard
Judy Edmonds*

NOMINATING COMMITTEE

*Clint Buetow
Joan Jolly
Trudy Decker
AJ Watland
Bruce Sutherland
Megan Valencia-Lashley*



Commissioning the 2025-26 council during worship in July 2025.

Report of the Endowment Committee

Trinity Lutheran Church and Schools congregational members and community have given generously to the Trinity Endowment Fund for many years. These monetary gifts make it possible for the Endowment Committee to award **educational scholarships, mission and emergency assistance grants.**

Charitable financial gifts are often made as special one time donations, ongoing regular designated donations, and memorials. These funds are transferred to the Trinity Lutheran Endowment Ministry Growth Fund at the ELCA. Our bylaws have a set formula that determines the amount we have available to share annually. We are grateful for the support of the TLCS community that allows us to help students, those in emergency situations and mission projects.

We continue to streamline the online application, post notices for due dates for student scholarship applications in the What's Happening, and provide information on the church website. We make announcements and reach out to Trinity leadership, office, and school staff to keep us in mind if they encounter someone that may benefit from the Endowment Fund.

Your compassionate and unselfish gifts allow us to award grants. It is heart warming to witness

the joy of students who receive a scholarship for college or university, the excitement that a mission grant can bring to volunteers and the relief of a person struggling in an emergency situation to receive financial support. Serving on the Endowment Committee gives us the opportunity to assist so many people and this is all due to the spirit of giving and kindness of the Trinity community.

In 2025 we were able to support our talented Trinity Quilters when their old donated sewing machines were beyond repair. This hardworking group gives generously of their time and talents to provide comfort to those in need. Your charitable gifts supported this worthy team with two new heavy duty machines so they can continue their much appreciated ministry.

We are grateful for the enthusiastic work of Claudia LaFollette and Lin Russell who both served multiple terms on our committee. We are thankful for the ongoing support and kindness of the TLCS staff. Thank you for giving us this opportunity to serve.

Blessings,

Inger Hamburg

Endowment Treasurer

Committee Members: Julie Buetow, Van Hutton, Ruth Lee, Jayne Meyer and Inger Hamburg

Contact endowment@tlcs.church for questions and grant information.

2025 Endowment Grants

\$4,353
for 4 Emergency Grants

\$2,306
for 1 Mission Grant

\$10,000
for 10 Education Grants

Worship & Hospitality

Every week, people walk through the doors of Trinity carrying the full weight of their lives — and every week, God meets them here. Worship is where we encounter the holy together, where we are named and claimed and sent back out into the world with something we didn't have before. Hospitality is the practice that makes that possible: the generous, unhurried welcome that says **there is room for you here, exactly as you are.**

In 2025, the worshipping community of Trinity gathered across seasons of joy and grief, of celebration and searching. What follows reflects the richness of that shared life — and the conviction that gathering together in God's name is never just a routine. It is an act of bold, communal faith.

Report of the Minister of Music & Worship

"Blessed are those whose strength is in you,
whose hearts are set on pilgrimage."
— Psalm 84:5 (NRSVUE)

THE SACRED PEREGRINATION

In the Celtic tradition, a Peregrination [per-i-gruh-ney-shuhn] is not a simple hike from point A to point B. It is a *peregrinatio*—a 'wandering for the love of God'—a sacred journey where the destination is less important than the spiritual transformation that happens along the way. This past year at Trinity has been exactly that: a soul-voyage through the seasons, where we leaned into the "thin places" where heaven and earth seem to touch.



LITURGY AND WORSHIP: WALKING THE THIN PLACES

Our worship this year was a rhythmic "rowing about" through the deep waters of faith. We didn't just observe the seasons; we traveled through them, letting the liturgy shape our pace.

Our path this year was paved with diverse stories: we moved from the overflowing abundance of **'Full to the Brim'** into the wonder of **'Tales of the Holy Imagination,'** eventually confronting the shadows in **'What Do We Fear?'** and finding beauty in the brokenness of **'Gold in the Fracture.'** Through it all, we practiced the art of being a pilgrim people—clinging to God's promises even when the trail grew dim. This journey reminded us that walking in faith requires both the strength to keep going and the courage to be undone. Yet, we also learned that even the most faithful traveler must eventually pause to listen for the still, small voice in the quiet.

Launched in June, our monthly **Sacred Pause** gatherings have become a vital rhythm in our peregrination. These contemplative afternoons teach us to find God not in the noise of doing, but in the simplicity of the breath and the stillness of a Tuesday. They have become our spiritual 'shore'—a place to beach our oars, rest, and reflect. In this cultivated quiet, we found the space to dream of new ways to honor our communal heritage and the saints who walked these thin places before us.

Celebrating the **Saint Brigid Feast Day** was a long-held dream realized. In that fellowship of music and poetry, we felt the true spirit of the *Anam Cara* (soul-friendship) that sustains our community. It was a reminder that we do not row these waters alone. If this soul-friendship is the heart of our community, then our shared songs have been its pulse, carrying us through the changing tides of the year.

From the nostalgia of Victorian Carols in Christmas in July to the evocative “Bless this Night” Holden Village liturgy in Advent, we have allowed **music to be the wind in our sails**. Our worship has become a richer, more sensory experience—one that engages not just the ear, but the heart and the body. We always carry the memory of when the organ swells, the lights fade, and the shared flame of Silent Night begins to spread—a physical manifestation of the light we carry into the world.

As that shared flame illuminated our faces, it also cast light on the very words we use to call God home. This year, our “wandering” also took us into new linguistic and melodic territories. We have intentionally sought out **inclusive and expansive language** in our liturgy and songs, ensuring our prayers reflect a God who is as vast as the universe and as intimate as a breath.

By **introducing new songs** that speak to our modern journey, we are expanding our vocabulary of praise to be more welcoming to all God’s children. This commitment to “expansive welcome” is not just a theological goal; it is a liturgical practice that turns every gathering into a “thin place” where everyone, regardless of where they are on their path, can hear their own story echoed in the divine.

If our worship is the landscape we walk together, then **my own wandering** this year has been about sharpening the tools and deepening the maps I use to guide us. As your Minister of Music & Worship, I have sought to integrate the intellectual and the artistic into the very craft of our shared life:

- **Sacred Study:** We delved into the complex landscapes of Revelation, the historical context of the First Advent in Palestine, and the foundational truths of the Small Catechism—reminding us that the pilgrim’s path is paved with both mystery and ancient wisdom.
- **Artist at the Organ:** Our concert series continues to be reimagined, ensuring every note serves a greater liturgical depth. A highlight of this journey was celebrating our organ’s 30th anniversary with Katelyn Emerson, a moment where the “voice” of our sanctuary sang with renewed brilliance.
- **New Creations:** I was honored to premiere a multimedia piece for the National Endowment for the Arts—a collaborative “wandering” that wove choreography and original music into a modern act of storytelling alongside over twenty professional artists from across the country including our very own, Vianne and Michael Reay.

LEADERSHIP & WIDER MINISTRY

Yet, a true peregrination is rarely a solo endeavor. The beauty of the ‘thin places’ is found in the people who walk them with us, and I am deeply grateful for those walking beside me in the wider church and our local community:

- **Radical Hospitality:** Working with Theresa Anderson and Megan Valencia-Lashley on the Diversity and Inclusion Ministry remains the work that speaks most directly to my soul. Together, we are reimagining ‘welcome’ not as a static greeting, but as an active, courageous, and liturgical way of life.
- **The Wider Church:** I am humbled to represent our community on the worship planning team for the 2027 ELCA Youth Gathering and to witness the dawn of a reforming ELCA alongside our newly elected presiding bishop.

As we look toward the horizon of the coming year, I am filled with gratitude for this ‘rowing

about' we do together. May we continue to seek the thin places, trust the wind in our sails, and find Christ in every fellow traveler we meet on the way.

"Will you go where you don't know and never be the same? Will you let my love be shown, will you let my name be known, will you let my life be grown in you and you in me?"

— John L. Bell, "The Summons" (Iona Community)

REFLECTING ON THE JOURNEY

As I look back on the miles we've traveled, I see generosity coming alive most vibrantly in the "community of the table." During our midweek Lenten meals and vespers, I witnessed a profound exchange of vulnerability—a unique form of stewardship where we offer not just our resources, but our true selves to our neighbors. **This spirit of giving is mirrored every week by the over 60 individuals who freely contribute to our Sunday liturgy.** How can this not be the work of the people? Their collective time and talent serve as the essential fuel that keeps our community moving forward on this shared pilgrimage.

This movement of the heart is precisely how our ministry helps faith become active in love. We see this love manifest in the sacred "moments of transition"—the hush of a memorial, the splash of baptismal waters, or the exuberant joy of a wedding. It is a deep honor to craft the music and prayers that meet you exactly where you are in these thin places. By holding space for these pivotal life moments, our ministry ensures that no one at Trinity has to walk their personal peregrination alone; we are bound together by a love that seeks the good of the other.

Looking toward the horizon, the hopes and opportunities I see for the year ahead lie in the deepening of our interior lives. I am eager to further integrate our contemplative practices into the daily rhythm of the congregation. My hope is that the "Sacred Pause" continues to expand, offering us a grounded center of gravity as the wider ELCA continues to navigate its own season

of neverending reformation. By rooting ourselves in silence and prayer, we prepare ourselves to extend God's generosity in even more expansive, transformative ways.

PERSONAL MILESTONES

While much of our wandering happens in community, there are moments on the path that define our individual calling. This year marked the end of a long, often bumpy road as I celebrated my Final Approval from Candidacy for Word and Service. Throughout the twists and turns of that process, your love and faith in me as a spiritual leader were the compass that kept me on course.

The theme of 'journey' hit home in my personal life as well. In June, Brett and I began our own lifelong peregrination together as we were married—a celebration of the ultimate Anam Cara. I also found myself testing the limits of the physical 'pilgrim' by completing the Ride from Seattle to Vancouver (RSVP), a reminder that whether on a bike or the organ bench, the journey requires both grit and grace.

"May you have the courage to listen to the voice of desire that disturbs you when you have settled into something too safe."

— John O'Donohue, "For the Traveler"

Thank you for allowing me to wander, wonder, and worship alongside you.

In Christ,

David Horton

Minister of Music & Worship



Discipleship & Faith Formation

Faith is not a destination — it is a journey, and it is almost never traveled alone. The Discipleship and Faith Formation ministry at Trinity exists to walk alongside people at every stage of that journey: from the very young to the very old, from those just beginning to ask questions to those who have been asking them for decades. This is what it looks like when a community takes seriously the call to grow together, to challenge one another, and to keep becoming more fully who God made us to be.

The work of faith formation is often quiet and slow, unfolding in conversations and classes, in small groups and Sunday mornings, in the lives of children who are learning to pray and adults who are learning to see the world through new eyes. Here is a record of that work in 2025 — offered as evidence of a community genuinely committed to the long, beautiful work of following Jesus.

Discipleship & Faith Formation carried a particular weight in 2025. In November, our Minister of Faith Formation, **David Greenlee**, began a long-term disability leave — and the community felt his absence. David has been a beloved presence at Trinity since 2002, and his roots here go even deeper than that: many will remember his leadership of the Jeremiah Center in the years before. His investment in the faith formation of this congregation spans decades, touching the lives of children who are now adults, families who found their footing here, and a community that is richer for his presence. We hold him and his family in prayer, and we carry his legacy forward in the work described below.

In David's absence, Faith Formation continued through a genuine community effort — Pastor Hector, David Horton, and a dedicated group of lay volunteers stepped in to keep programming alive and connected. We are **especially grateful** to **Jenny Vanderwerff** for her faithful coordination of Sunday School, and to **Kerry Flieger-Holmes, Mark Schmidt, Laura Maier and Megan Valencia-Lashly** for their leadership of our youth programs. This is what it looks like when a congregation lives out its faith together.

Children & Family Ministry

Sunday School continued throughout 2025, gathering children regularly for faith formation rooted in scripture, story, and community.

It is a small but vital expression of Trinity's commitment to nurturing faith from the very beginning — and a reminder that investing in our youngest members is one of the most generous things we do as a congregation.

Student Ministry

Trinity's high school group (NET) and middle school group (ZOE) both met regularly throughout 2025 — a genuinely encouraging sign of life and continuity. Following David's leave, the two groups joined together for Sunday evening programming, with middle schoolers participating twice a month. The combined gatherings created space for shared activities and intergenerational connection among our young people, while smaller group time allowed for age-appropriate Bible study and deeper conversation.

ZOE continues Trinity's Affirmation of Faith process — our approach to what many congregations call Confirmation — walking middle schoolers through a formational journey of scripture, faith, and community. The persistence of both groups through a year of transition speaks well of the students themselves and of the adults who showed up for them.

A special thanks to Erik Harada, Pat Smith, and Sue Myers for their ongoing support and leadership with Student ministry activities.

Adult Formation

Wednesday evening Bible study remained the anchor of adult faith formation in 2025, continuing its steady rhythm throughout the year as a space for study, conversation, and community.

Beyond the weekly gathering, 2025 also offered several focused formation opportunities. David Horton led **Unpacking the Purple** during Lent, exploring the season's themes with depth

and care, and returned later in the year with a Sunday series on the **book of Revelation. Seventy-Seven Times**, a four-session series on Christian forgiveness led by Mary Denny, invited participants into one of the faith's most challenging and liberating practices. And two forums on **End of Life Planning** and **Hospice Care** offered the congregation something rarer still: an honest, faith-grounded space to face the questions most of us would rather avoid — exactly the kind of bold, generous ministry that serves people where they actually live.



Care Ministry

When life becomes too heavy to carry alone, God moves through people. The Care Ministry at Trinity is one of the most tangible expressions of what it means to live out faith working through love — showing up in hospital rooms, living rooms, and moments of grief with presence, prayer, and the quiet assurance that no one faces the hard things alone. This is generosity in its most intimate form: the offering of time, attention, and compassion to another person at the moment they need it most.

In 2025, God was at work through every prayer offered, every visit made, every hand held, and every meal delivered. What follows is a glimpse of that ministry — and an invitation to consider how you, too, might be called to show up for someone in the year ahead.

Stephen Ministry

GENEROSITY EXPRESSED THROUGH CHRISTIAN CARE

Throughout 2025, the Stephen Ministry team at Trinity Lutheran Church continued to embody a spirit of generosity in every caring relationship. Our ministers offered their time, presence,

and compassion to care receivers from both within the congregation and the surrounding community. This generosity was reflected in the steady, faithful commitment of our ministers as they walked alongside individuals experiencing grief, illness, life transitions, and personal challenges. Their willingness to listen, pray, and provide ongoing support demonstrated the heart of Christ's call to love one another.

ONE-ON-ONE SUPPORT FOR CARE RECEIVERS

Stephen Ministry remained a vital part of Trinity's overall pastoral care this year. Through multiple assigned caring relationships, our Stephen Ministers provided confidential, one-on-one Christian care to individuals in times of need. Each minister is trained, prepared, and committed to offering high-quality support whenever a new care receiver is assigned. Regular supervision meetings and continuing education sessions strengthened the team's skills and ensured that care remained grounded in compassion, confidentiality, and Christian presence. In 2025, our ministers continued to serve as steady companions for those navigating difficult seasons of life.



PREPARING FOR GROWTH AND LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

Looking ahead, Trinity's Stephen Ministry anticipates meaningful growth in the coming year. Plans are underway to recruit and train additional Stephen Ministers to expand our capacity to serve both the congregation and the broader community. In addition, we look forward to commissioning a new Stephen Leader in May 2026. This added leadership will support training efforts, strengthen program coordination, and help sustain the ministry's long-term vitality. With these developments, we are preparing to broaden our reach and continue offering compassionate, Christ-centered care to all who seek it.

Sheri Kasen-Kessler
Stephen Ministry Leader

Pastoral Care Ministry

At the heart of pastoral care is a compassionate, supportive relationship with individuals — offering a listening ear, emotional support, and spiritual guidance, particularly in times of need. It is rooted in the teaching, love, and care exemplified by Jesus. Essentially, it's about being present with people and helping them navigate life's challenges through the lens of faith.

Pastoral Care Ministers are a vital part of the pastoral care team at TLCS, engaging with and caring for people — meeting them in their struggles, doubts, and vulnerabilities. They serve both within the congregation and in the wider community: following up with every prayer request made to TLCS, making hospital, care facility, and homebound visits, celebrating communion, and serving our Neighbors in Need on Saturday mornings.

Our Pastoral Care Ministers have been trained as Stephen Ministers and have completed many additional hours of training — a journey of self-discovery of their personal and pastoral identity, with opportunity to develop and refine pastoral skills under supervision. The team meets monthly for mutual support, ongoing supervision, and continuing education.

Pastoral care is an essential component of a thriving church community. As Trinity continues to grow, it is crucial to strengthen this ministry by training and equipping more people with pastoral skills. There is a need for additional Pastoral Care Ministers, and we invite you to prayerfully consider whether this one-on-one caring ministry might be your calling.

We pray that God continues to empower us for this task — and that we may all be both willing servants and grateful recipients of pastoral care.

Submitted by
Liz Gimmestad

Prayer Shawl Ministry

This group meets on the first and third Tuesday of each month, from 1–3 pm. All are welcome to join, whether once to learn or as an ongoing member.

Our shawls incorporate the love of knitting and crocheting. Made with prayer and intention — blessings are intended with every stitch — they are given away freely and unconditionally, never to be sold.

They can be used to reach out to those in need of comfort and solace: those undergoing medical procedures, those experiencing loss or bereavement, or anyone seeking comfort in times of stress, prayer, or meditation. They also mark celebrations and joy: commitment or marriage ceremonies, births, bridal showers, graduations, birthdays, anniversaries, ordinations, holiday gifts — or just socializing.

Currently we maintain a supply of approximately 24 shawls. We create basic “3-stitch” shawls but also encourage each other to explore more intricate patterns; we find joy in this craft together. This year we also created 10 table runners for the Synod meeting last May — these were returned to Trinity for use as altar cloths, for general church events, and as Prayer Shawls. We also learned to make fingerless gloves to support the Neighbors in Need mission’s cold weather supplies for those they serve.

Our yarn supply comes through monetary or yarn donations; this ministry is not funded by the church budget. Of note: we discovered an amazing yarn and equipment source through the Linus Project’s craft sale at Zion Lutheran Church in Snohomish, held every August.

Our hope for the future is to discover and grow our “Knitting/Crocheting Warrior” ranks. Instructions and yarn kits are available on request — kits can be completed at home or during our twice-monthly sessions, and help is always available.

“Shawls ... made for centuries universal and embracing, symbolic of an inclusive, unconditionally loving God. They wrap, enfold, comfort, cover, give solace, mother, hug, shelter and beautify. Those who have received these shawls have been uplifted and affirmed, as if given wings to fly above their troubles...”

— Janet Severi Bristow, 1998

Nancy Sutherland

on behalf of the Prayer Shawl Ministry group



Service & Justice

Living generously and loving boldly means more than meeting immediate needs — it means asking harder questions about why those needs exist, and joining God’s work to heal what is broken. The Service & Justice ministry at Trinity is rooted in the belief that faith without action is incomplete, and that real love sometimes calls us to be persistent, even inconvenient, in our pursuit of a more just and whole world.

From our partnership with the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center to the ways we show up for neighbors near and far, God has been at work through this congregation in 2025 — not as an institution doing good, but as a community of people whose faith keeps working its way outward into the world. Here is a record of that work, offered with gratitude and with eyes open to what comes next.

Diversity & Inclusion Ministry

Rooted in the transformative love modeled by Jesus Christ, the Diversity and Inclusion Ministry is dedicated to cultivating a community where the inherent dignity of every person is honored and celebrated.

Our focus this year was **strategic alignment** and **shared stewardship** - creating practical ways for our congregation and local community to engage, learn, and make an impact. By formalizing a co-leadership structure, we fostered a shared mission and transitioned more ownership to ministry team members, which also lightened the load on supporting staff. These changes have helped us operate more effectively and increased awareness of our ministry’s priorities. The goals we’ve

set for this year are designed to build stronger relationships within TLCS, the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center, and faith communities in the area, furthering our collective understanding and commitment to diversity and inclusion.

We received approval from church council to **adopt a community facing covenant statement**¹ that clearly articulates the ministry’s vision and focus areas. At council’s request, we shared this covenant with the leaders of all TLCS ministry groups as well as the Trinity Childcare Development Center and Preschool with a message inviting them to consider how these values and focus areas could enhance their work by starting from a foundation of inclusion and celebration of the uniqueness of every individual. This covenant supports decision making for TLCS leaders by ensuring all guests and events using Trinity’s worship and facility spaces are aligned to the covenant and are committed to supporting it through their offering. This covenant, along with community resources, monthly awareness messages, and local events of interest, is now posted on the new DIM Message Board displayed in the narthex.

The ministry’s generosity and impact came alive through events and activities that reached far beyond our church walls. In June, TLCS members proudly joined the NWWA Synod in the **Seattle Pride Parade**, affirming our commitment to visibility and welcome. We engaged our



Adoptive & Crucifer roles typically done by multi-generational families.

1 - tlcs.church/dim



congregation in a **book study of Pastor Aaron Scott's** *Bring Back Your People: Ten Ways Regular Folks Can Put a Dent in White Christian Nationalism* and were honored to **welcome Pastor Scott as a guest preacher in July.**² In partnership with Paths to Understanding, we hosted a Potluck Project event, inviting community and faith leaders to connect over a shared meal and open conversation. To show love for our neighbors and support those in need, we organized the **Advent Dignity Food Drive**³ for the Lynnwood Food Bank, focusing on culturally significant foods that are often hard to find at food banks.

We created opportunities for our congregation to show outward support for historically marginalized groups and individuals. During a ministry moment, we spoke about the importance of safe spaces where everyone can show up as their full, authentic selves, and we distributed nearly 200 **"You are Safe with Me"** pins which continue to bring us joy when we see them proudly worn at church. At our **Thanksgiving Eve service,**⁴ we led the congregation in gathering to give thanks while also holding space for those who experience grief or harm during this holiday, acknowledging the complexity of its history.

2 - tlcs.church/post/sermon-exactly-where-she-needs-to-be

3 - tlcs.church/post/preparing-the-way-advent-dignity-food-drive

4 - youtu.be/mRBG8Wj2Vwo

Looking to the year ahead, our ministry remains committed to **inviting involvement, education, action, and reflection.** Through quarterly ministry moments, monthly Awareness Posts in the bulletin and on social media, bi-annual educational forums, and ongoing partnerships with community organizations and the Lynnwood Neighborhood Center, we will offer many ways to deepen our shared understanding of diversity and inclusion—not just as a concept, but as a lived call to action. We warmly invite you to support us through prayer, participation, or joining our monthly meetings, held on the 4th Tuesday of each month at 6:30 PM here at TLCS. Whether you have questions, resources to share, or are interested in joining this vital work, you are always welcome.

In Christ's love,

The Diversity and Inclusion Ministry

Co-Leaders Theresa Anderson & Megan Valencia-Lashley, Staff Ministry Team Leader David Horton, Susan Erikson, Liz Gimmestad, Kirsten Lunstrum, Judy & Rudy Schleusner, Michelle Weber, Kris Patterson, Colleen Collins, Sue Carlson, Joan Jolly



Esperanza

2026 marks 27 years of partnership between TLCS and Esperanza International. We also celebrate serving alongside Esperanza building community and relationships while providing safe, dignified homes for families in the greater Tijuana area.

We are thrilled to announce that Esperanza International reached their goal of raising the funds for 3 special circumstance homes and a new community center. Construction on the community center in Lomas del Valle will begin this year! 2026 will bring new challenges along with new and exciting projects.

As one of the few “open” groups that volunteer with Esperanza, we have a unique opportunity to grow our mission—both here in Lynnwood and across the country—inviting anyone who feels called to share in this experience. Belonging to a community greater than ourselves. Belonging to one another, to those we know and those we have yet to meet, and to a community in another part of our world. Becoming better global citizens—learning through education and experience with open hearts and open minds. Becoming community by strengthening relationships with our TLCS family, with others from across the country, and with our neighbors in Mexico.

Each trip continues to reveal that transformation is not just for the families whose homes are being built, but also for those of us who serve alongside them. We encounter different cultures, embrace and love those differences, and create cross-border relationships. We have seen the face of Jesus smiling back at us in the people we meet and work with. We have discovered one way to be the hands of God in a world of need.

With every mission trip, we seek to expand our community—sharing the joy of giving and serving with all who wish to take part. We have been, and continue to be, deeply blessed by our partnership with Esperanza. Thank you to all who continue to support Esperanza in so many ways. Our 2026 trip is August 8-15. Head to mexico.trinitylutheranchurch.com to learn more.

Submitted by

Deb Johnson & Cliff Bronson



Posing after a hard day's work building a house.



Teamwork needed to pour all that concrete!



Chatting with the family we're building a house for.

Gardening for Neighbors

Gardening for Neighbors has been all about abundance and supporting Neighbors in Need with fresh, organic produce. The ministry has been blessed with donations of seeds, seedlings, tools, soil, fertilizers, cash contributions, and time. Active members of the ministry care for the garden by giving an hour or two each week or every other week to such chores as watering, weeding and harvesting.

Harvesting begins late spring with lettuce, kale, and radishes. Squash, cucumbers, carrots, onions, and tomatoes are quick to follow. Each week's harvest is donated to Neighbors in Need. What a colorful display in the NiN pantry! Fresh produce is a rare treat for all, including families who come for breakfast. Our neighbors express their heartfelt appreciation to NiN volunteers for fresh vegetables.

The generosity of the Gardening for Neighbors ministry expands beyond our Trinity campus.

Members of the congregation share from their own gardens. This adds cabbage, several varieties of squash, more carrots, additional radishes, peas, and berries. A blessing of this combined abundance is that we can share. All produce that remains at the end of Saturday morning is taken to Edmonds Food Bank. Our NiN guests are proud of this chance to "give back". Our giving becomes mutual.

Trinity's Gardening for Neighbors ministry creates abundance during a summer of warm sunshine and occasional gentle rain. The team includes volunteers of all ages and abilities. Opportunities are available to help with planting and the occasional work party, water weekly, pull a few weeds, and/or harvest vegetables. All are welcome to join Gardening for Neighbors!

Submitted by

Mike Schultz & Joan Jolly



Pastor Hector working in the garden



A bounty of fresh veggies distributed each Saturday to Neighbors in Need



Gardening for Neighbors work party.

Living Water

The purpose of the Living Water Ministry is to empower communities worldwide with safe and reliable uses of water. Right now, 703 million people around the world lack access to the basic necessity of clean water. We at Living Water are working to change this statistic for the lives of those affected. We strive to “Live Generously” giving our time, efforts, and resources to enable others to realize the blessing of clean water. The ministry members feel blessed and honored that all of us “Loving Boldly” can share the generosity of our church members with people that are forgotten, bringing their plight to the forefront, and helping them to know they are loved.

In May, the Living Water team was present at our **NW Synod Assembly** sharing the Living Water Ministry of Trinity Lutheran Church and Schools with the gathering. Our team had a table where we shared how the generosity of Trinity Lutheran and Edmonds Lutheran Churches have funded Clean Water projects throughout the world. A video presentation was also made to the Assembly.

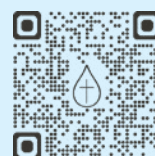
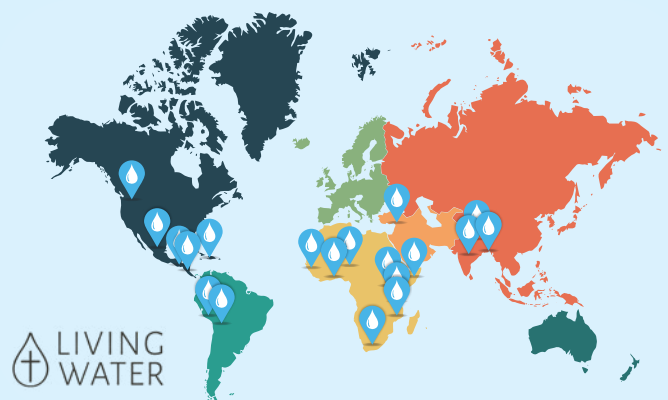
This outreach **planted a seed which bore fruit** in November. The Lord of Life Lutheran Church in Renton decided to support the work of the Living Water Ministry with their donations. Living Water also has a connection with Island of Faith Lutheran Church in Wrangell, Alaska, which periodically sends in donations from their congregation. The next Synod Assembly is in 2027, where we hope to connect with the wider church community sharing once again how Living Generously can make a huge difference in the lives of people lacking access to clean water.

With the grace of God, our congregation, in partnership with Edmonds Lutheran Church and the support of Lord of Life Lutheran Church in Renton, and Island of Faith Lutheran Church in Wrangell, Alaska, **received donations of \$48,355 in 2025**. Living Water has given \$29,250 toward water projects this year. Most of the balance remaining at the end of 2025 (resulting from

significant donations in December) have already been allocated to other projects totaling \$21,218 in January 2026! This supports communities in dire need of clean water for drinking, bathing, and sanitation. Among the projects we supported in 2025 were:

- **\$10,000** to Water 1st, Savar, Bangladesh, for a piped water system and flush toilets serving 50 people.
- **\$4,250** to Esperanza International, Lomas del Valle, Tijuana, Mexico, for rooftop water tanks serving 5 families.
- **\$10,000** to Odrino USA, Nan Kisa, Haiti, for a Solaram® solar pump for a spring serving 2000 people.
- **\$5,000** to El Porvenir, Montes Verdes, Camoapa, Nicaragua, for a drilled well serving 140 people.

Many of the markers represent multiple grants over many years to the same location, organization, or region. All told, the Living Water Ministry—as a result of your generosity lived out over a decade—has given over \$1,100,000 to support water and water-adjacent projects both locally and globally.



*Out of the believer's heart
shall flow rivers of living water.
- John 7:38b*

Living Water ministry goals for 2026 and beyond are :

1. To **reach out to other churches** and the larger community to invite their support of the Living Water ministry.
2. Continue to **explore avenues to connect** with potential clean water needs throughout the globe.
3. Prepare to **attend the 2027 Synod Assembly**, promoting the work that Living Water is doing and extend an invitation to join in this work.
4. **Promote the 2027 Water 1st annual "Walk for Water"**, a one-hour event in Seattle which happens on World Water Day (March 22nd this year). The projects aimed for by this walk help women and girls regain time lost to fetching water, improve health, and increase educational opportunities.

Through your generous support the families receiving the gift of clean water have been able to have dignity, health, and life restored to them. T

he Living Water Ministry usually meets monthly on the third Monday at 6 PM via ZOOM. We welcome anyone who is interested to join us in our ministry.

Judy Jacobson

Living Water committee chair



John Judd & Judy Jacobson at Synod Assembly

Neighbors in Need

Neighbors in Need's mission is to serve all people by providing basic support services, encouragement, and unconditional acceptance within a safe, caring environment. This program extends God's love through neighborly compassion and respect to anyone facing life's challenges, while inspiring all to continue in our shared quest for wholeness.

The NiN ministry at TLCS consists of the Saturday Morning breakfast, the Emergency Cold Weather Shelter, and the Toy Shop of South Snohomish County.

If no one reports, did Neighbors in Need actually happen?

Absolutely! We continue to be a primary support to our unhoused and low-income friends and neighbors in Lynnwood, Edmonds, and Mountlake Terrace.

Each Saturday morning, 25–30 rotating volunteers from several partner organizations hand out 80–100 bags and 3–4 family food boxes per week of non-perishable food and Trader Joe's sandwiches and salads provided by the Edmonds Food Bank (35,751 pounds in the last 12 months) and Advocates Recovery Services; fresh fruit, string cheese, and hard-boiled eggs provided by the Edmonds Unitarian Congregation; and shoes, coats, and clothing provided by Trinity and our neighborhood friends. Every week, Jude picks up bread and rolls from Franz Bakery.

Since September 2022, we have returned to serving indoor hot breakfast — burritos and coffee, as well as scrambled eggs and sausage or biscuits and gravy with all the trimmings — with help from friends at TLCS, Holy Rosary, Gloria Dei Lutheran Church, Edmonds Unitarian Congregation, PEMCO, St. Philopater & St. Demiana Coptic Orthodox Church (Lynnwood), Archangels Coptic Orthodox Church (Everett), and The Nest Mission. You can follow us at nintrinity.org.



Pantry distribution on a Saturday morning

Every other week, street medicine **doctors and nurses from MercyWatch and Advocates Recovery Services** provided health checks, wound care, follow-up with Neighbors receiving medical care, and a listening ear for health concerns.

This past year, NiN was blessed by the **Medical Team International dental van**, on site at least one Saturday each month. Volunteer dentists and hygienists provided fillings, extractions, and cleanings to uninsured Neighbors of all ages. Each patient received clear after-care instructions. Return to good dental health lengthens life — and a common comment after even serious procedures is simply: “They are so nice!”

The **Toy Shop** again provided Christmas gifts to over 600 children from more than 200 families, with donations from Toys for Tots, the Edmonds Unitarian Congregation, TLCS families and neighbors, Lynnwood Kiwanis, Lynnwood LDS Church, and NW Church — distributed with the help of volunteers from the Lynnwood, Edmonds, and MLT Food Banks, the Lynnwood LDS Church, and TLCS and Unitarian members and friends.

Through the Jean Kim Foundation, we continue to support the **Lynnwood Hygiene Station** (showers and bathrooms). Through The Nest Mission, laundry services and Friday night services are provided. NiN also continued to provide Advocates Recovery Services with backpacks loaded with hygiene products for their homeless outreach program offering detox

and sobriety services. None of this could have happened without the generous contributions of TLCS members and friends, holiday concerts, Gloria Dei Lutheran Church, St. Hilda St. Patrick Episcopal Church, Holy Rosary Catholic Church, and the North Sound Church.

STORIES OF GRACE AND HOPE

- **Amber and Kyle** maintained a household in their SUV for 13 years. Two months ago, they picked up keys to an apartment — new, shiny-clean, and very comfortable. A good night’s sleep and access to their own bathroom and kitchen has given them the emotional strength to keep moving forward. Kyle is successfully finding jobs, and Amber, whose health has always been fragile, is now scheduling regular medical support.
- **Joey** has been a favorite Neighbor for several years. He is deaf and especially loves Peggy, who is proficient in ASL — with the rest of us, he is generous with good-natured texting. Several months ago, he was hit by a car while walking to Neighbors in Need. He is still in a rehab facility but will soon move into safe housing, and has stayed in frequent contact with NiN volunteers throughout. He will always be a well-loved Neighbor.
- **Jerry** has been homeless in Lynnwood for at least 20 years and a regular guest at Neighbors in Need for many of them. When social service providers realized they could always find him on Saturday mornings, they were able to follow up consistently. He now has SSI income with direct deposit, medical insurance, and a safe home in an RV. He has reconnected with family and is intentional about his health. What a change.

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Saturday morning is only possible because of a great deal of effort throughout the entire week. When we open at 7 am with hot coffee, a large background crew — Alan, David, and several Neighbors — has already set up 9–12 tables with chairs where guests can enjoy coffee, breakfast, and companionship, along with at least 8 long

tables for the pantry food bank, 4 long tables and 15 chairs for the clothing bank, and 2 tables for medical resources. Jude, Chris, Kyo, John, Aaron, Chris, and Chuck set up the food bank area for efficient distribution and fill at least 80–90 grocery bags alongside Jeff and willing volunteers from the breakfast teams. Rick, Peggy, Sue, and Ellie serve as fashion advisors for the clothing bank — a serious gift of genuine care. Three and a half hours later, it all gets put away and the cleanup begins. It's a busy and very meaningful ministry.

Looking back over the past year reminds us that Neighbors in Need is a neighborhood in the traditional sense of the word. Local service organizations trust and partner with NiN. We introduce our Neighbors to representatives of agencies who can effectively advocate for them, and we are grateful for this opportunity — not only to build relationships with those we serve, but with our many volunteers and partners as well. Every Saturday, we give thanks for the chance to safely serve indoor breakfast again, knowing this ministry matters as much to our volunteers as it does to our Neighbors.

Respectfully submitted by NiN Leadership: Joan Jolly, John Boone, Chris Frizzell, Sarah Merrihew-Fox, Lila Robinson, Chuck Hoffman, and Aaron Linstrom.

Submitted by
John Boone & Joan Jolly
On behalf of the NiN Board



Saturday morning food service.



Quilters ready for Quilt Sunday

Quilt Ministry

Through the talents of a few quilters we have produced some beautiful quilt tops. On our regular Quilt Day (most Thursdays at 9 AM), our wonderful quilters have tied and pinned the quilts. Finally, the backings are sewn, and we have some beautiful quilts which we send out to wherever they are needed.

The need for quilts is great, especially where war is happening, where weather disasters are occurring, or where people are homeless. Not only do we help those in need, but we minister to each other — listening to each other's needs or problems, encouraging each other in times of trouble, and generally showing care and concern to each other.

Each year before we ship the quilts we have a Mission Sunday where our quilts are blessed. On these Sundays, we have had church members come forward and state that they will join our quilters group once they have retired from active employment. Also, we have posted articles in local newspapers about our quilter's group and have acquired new members from outside our church community.

Submitted by,
Tena Schultz
on behalf of the Quilters

Staff

Hector Garfias-Toledo + Lead Pastor
David Horton + Minister of Music & Worship
Don Boelter + Administrator
Josh Judd-Herzfeldt + Communication Coordinator
Kelly Apling + Ministry Assistant
Carl Setzer + Pastoral Care & Admin. Assistant
Paul Burns + Facilities & Maintenance Coordinator
Joelle Dudak + Preschool Director
Nanette Erban + Child Care Director

2025-26 Congregation Council

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Clint Buetow + vice president
Mike Schultz + treasurer
Jenny Louch + secretary
Mark Bergquist
Mary Denny
Judy Jacobson
Mark Reay
Edy Strand



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